

A Self-Closing Gate Conundrum

#1 Victory Royale

Element L: Presentation of Designer's Recommendations

Student G's family needs a self-closing mechanism that closes their family's gate on its own because his family does not want unwanted animals and people to get inside their fence gate because it is a safety concern that could cause injury. This happens because student G's gate can not close on its own.

Something our group would recommend is to find a device that keeps the metal spring and clamps from rubbing against aluminum, plastic or wooden fences. Doing that will prevent wear and tear towards the fence. We recommend using a soft piece of material to prevent scratches, dents, cracking, and paint chips. We recommend a more durable and weatherproof material rather than galvanized aluminum.

Something our group could have done better is to think of ways our device might affect the fence, that includes scratches, dents, cracking, and paint chips. Another improvement we could make to our prototype is not using zip ties to hold the soft material to the clamp because they slip on the metal fence and. We also should have sewed the fabric together so the metal prototype does not chip the paint on student G's fence.